

North Shore High: Mean Girls

Thomas Jefferson Model United Nations Conference

TechMUN XXXIII



High School Specialized Agency

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Dear Delegates,

Welcome to TechMUN XXXIII's Mean Girls committee! We are so excited to hear you all debate on the two pressing issues at North Shore High. This committee takes place at the time the movie was released (early 2000's), but also focuses on issues relevant to today's high school experience. Each delegate in this committee represents a different individual playing an important role in the Mean Girls Franchise, whether as a student, teacher, or parent. Each is expected to reflect on their views and the vision of football. Be sure to bring those views and ideologies into TechMUN XXXII weekend.

As your chairs, we are looking for delegates with strong speaking skills, ability to work diplomatically with others, and creative solutions tackling the topic at hand. Each position has a unique feature, and we want to see collaborative solutions while keeping your delegation's role in Mean Girls in mind. In addition to sharing ideas in moderated caucuses, we will also be looking for your role during unmoderated caucuses in both voicing your ideas and making sure others are heard as well. We want to see solutions that highlight your role while also remaining true to the time period.

With that being said, both of us hope that we can make your experience in committee as close to the movie as possible with some fun, creative twists. Through this experience, we want you to grow as delegates and communicate your ideas to the world, while taking risks in committee as much as possible. We want you to leave this conference as delegates who can be confident in their abilities and be able to use them outside of Model UN. If you have any questions at all, please do not hesitate to email us at meangirlstechmun2026@gmail.com, and we look forward to seeing you at TechMUN XXXIII!

Ameya Rao and Saisha Doma

Committee Background and Introduction

Note: If you are unfamiliar with any of the terms or processes detailed in this background guide, please view the resources listed on the NFL Football Operations website (operations.nfl.com), which provides explanations of terms, processes, and strategies related to team management, player evaluation, and game rules. Please email commanderstechmun2025@gmail.com for any clarifications.

North Shore High School is a suburban American high school known for its competitive environment and social hierarchies. For many years, the school's informal governance has been dominated not by the student council, but by powerful social groups that have an extreme influence through reputation, popularity, and gossip. Among these groups, the most influential has been a trio of students who rose through sharing gossip and having social control, the Plastics.

By the early 2000's, the Plastics, led by Regina George, had effectively consolidated power over the school's entire social structure. Their influence extended beyond simply fashion trends and lunchroom seating to even shaping reputations and determining social groups. The key portion of the Plastics dominance was the Burn Book, an unofficial and anonymous collection of rumors, accusations, and personal attacks against both students and faculty. Though it was initially hidden, widespread chaos occurred when the Burn Book was exposed by Cady Heron, the schools' new girl who unintentionally fell into a trap of fame and power. Emergency assemblies were held and punishments occurred, as students were encouraged to reflect on their personalities and their impacts on their friends. However, the Burn Book release effects on trust and leadership continue to remain unsolved.

In the following years, North Shore High has attempted to rebuild its community by emphasizing inclusivity and compassion among all students. However, the old hierarchy continues to influence behavior and new forms of social media have emerged. As

Topic 1: Burn Book 2.0: Resurfaces as a digital platform

Relevant Issues

North Shore High is currently facing a crisis. After the original Burn Book, made by Regina George, had been released to the school for everyone to see, the faculty dealt with it. This has sufficed for now, but the digital era of technology has caused the problem to resurface. Now, hateful messages about all people at North Shore High are being spread around on a digital platform with no evidence of who created or developed the website.

One of the major issues is the anonymity of the platform because it can intensify the harm caused by the post. Students feel emboldened to post messages about people that they would not say publicly or in-person, leading to much more hateful, inappropriate content. Students are also able to hide their true identity on the platform, making it increasingly harder to trace back messages to an individual. Unlike the original Burn Book, a single physical object created by the Plastics, the digital version allows multiple users to anonymously view, edit, and add content. This makes it significantly harder for school administration to identify those responsible and shut down the site entirely, as well as increasing difficulty to stop the spread of rumours once they are published.

Another key issue is the long-term social and emotional impact on students. The digital Burn Book operates continuously and constantly, meaning harmful messages circulate far beyond school hours and can reach a large audience, whether that be students at North Shore High or not. Victims are unable to escape the harassment, which has been leading to increased anxiety, damaged reputations, and a hostile school environment. The original incident was able to be addressed and contained by faculty, but the digital format allows the content to constantly be updated and resurface repeatedly, which intensifies mistrust and prolongs conflict between students.

Monitoring these online platforms requires technological resources, staff training, and clear policies regarding digital conduct, all of which place strain on the school's limited resources. North Shore High must decide how much authority it can reasonably exercise on student-created digital spaces while respecting privacy and free expression. Without these measures, attempts to shut down the digital burn Book will remain ineffective and may push the behavior to new levels, allowing the problem to persist rather than be resolved.

Possible Solutions

To address the challenges posed by the resurfacing of the Burn Book in a digital format and to protect the school environment at North Shore High, several strategies can be explored. School administrators and districts can adapt and change their policies relating to electronic platforms to reflect the developments of the digital world. This could include clearer guidelines on cyberbullying, stricter consequences for harassment, and explicit rules on student conduct for online content specifically outside of school hours..

Improving education and awareness among students is also crucial. North Shore High can implement mandatory digital citizenship programs that teach students about the consequences of

online harassment, responsible social media use, and the importance of empathy in digital spaces. These programs aim to reduce participation in the digital Burn Book platform by addressing and educating the root causes of behavior, rather than resorting to immediate punishment.

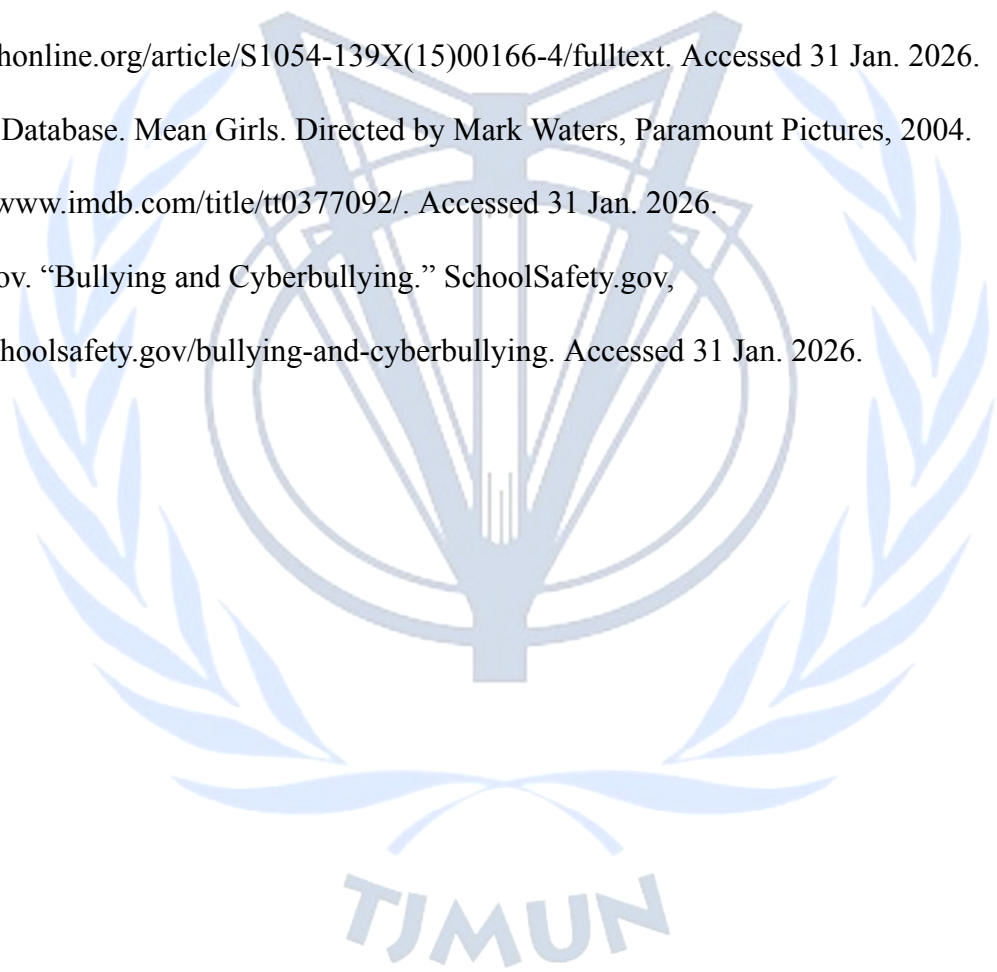
Collaboration between school officials, parents, and technology platforms is another important solution. It is the school's responsibility to have effective communication with the parents about the events circulating online, so they can work together to repair damaged relationships and address emotional harm. By focusing on accountability, education and student well-being, North Shore High can repair the damage caused by the digital Burn Book and reduce the likelihood of similar incidents happening as technology continues to grow and develop.

Questions to Consider

- 1) How can North Shore High protect students from online harassment and reputational harm while still recognizing that social media is a normal part of student life?
- 2) How can school policies be adjusted to hold students accountable for harmful online behavior without unfairly limiting free expression or overstepping on school authority?
- 3) What role can technology play in identifying and reporting harmful content, and how can these tools be used responsibly without violating student anonymity?
- 4) How can North Shore High balance short-term actions, such as discipline or content removal, with long-term solutions that promote empathy, student well-being, and foster a positive school environment?

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Topic 2: Mini-Plastic Groups Arise at North Shore High

Relevant Issues

In the aftermath of the Burn Book incident, North Shore High has entered a period of social instability. While the Burn Book temporarily dismantled the dominance of the Plastics, it did not eliminate the pre-existing systems of popularity, influence, and reputation management that defined student life at North Shore High. Instead, this resulted in the rise of multiple smaller and highly organized groups, referred to as “Mini-Plastic” groups.

These Mini-Plastics consist of underclassmen freshman and sophomores who have adopted certain elements of strategies of the original Plastics, such as controlling the flow of gossip, enforcing social power, and using reputation as a leverage. The groups are rising everywhere and adopting the personality of the original Plastics, such as their fashion, language and social tactics. What was once multiple cliques with their own uniqueness now became a multitude of groups who mimic these exact Plastics. The rapid rise has caused significant discomfort among the student body, particularly among younger students who fear becoming targets of exclusion or ridicule.

Specifically, the former Plastics themselves have expressed strong opposition to these imitation groups. Regina George and her former allies have publicly distanced themselves from the Mini-Plastics, viewing them as awful distortions of their past influence and a future threat to their own reputations. This rejection has further increased social instability, as underclassmen are eager to imitate the originals but lack the visibility from their true idols.

Faculty members and administrators are increasingly alarmed. Reports of coordinated social exclusion, anonymous group chats, and even rumors of a new Burn Book have arisen across the school, though no single group can clearly be held responsible for the abundance of

Mini-Plastics. Teachers describe the school environment filled with stress and unease, with regular students reluctant to speak openly in class or participate in any extracurricular activities due to fear of social ridicule.

The decentralized nature of the Mini-Plastics has made administration intervention difficult. Unlike the original plastics, these Mini-Plastics are separated yet remain connected, spreading their influence through digital platforms and informal networks. In other words, though the groups remain separate, their shared negative influence on the community has been immense for both students and the administration. This diffusion of power has created confusion which students should be held accountable and how this situation can be resolved.

As North Short High approaches new academic terms, the school community faces a critical decision point. Without any decision action, the Mini-Plastics risk creating a new era of social control, one more chaotic, less visible, and more damaging than the originals.

Possible Solutions

As North Shore High confronts the rapid threat of the underclassmen-led Mini-Plastic groups, the administration must evaluate multiple response strategies. Each potential solution carries significant advantages as well as risks, and no single approach guarantees immediate resolution. Delegates are expected to weigh these options carefully, considering both short-term stabilization and long-term cultural reform.

A potential solution that has been proposed by the student council and other student advocates is the implementation of stricter oversight for the social activity of underclassmen. Regulations such as the mandatory registration of informal clubs, assigned faculty advisors, and a stricter underclassmen student council can clear up behavior guidelines among the Mini-Plastic

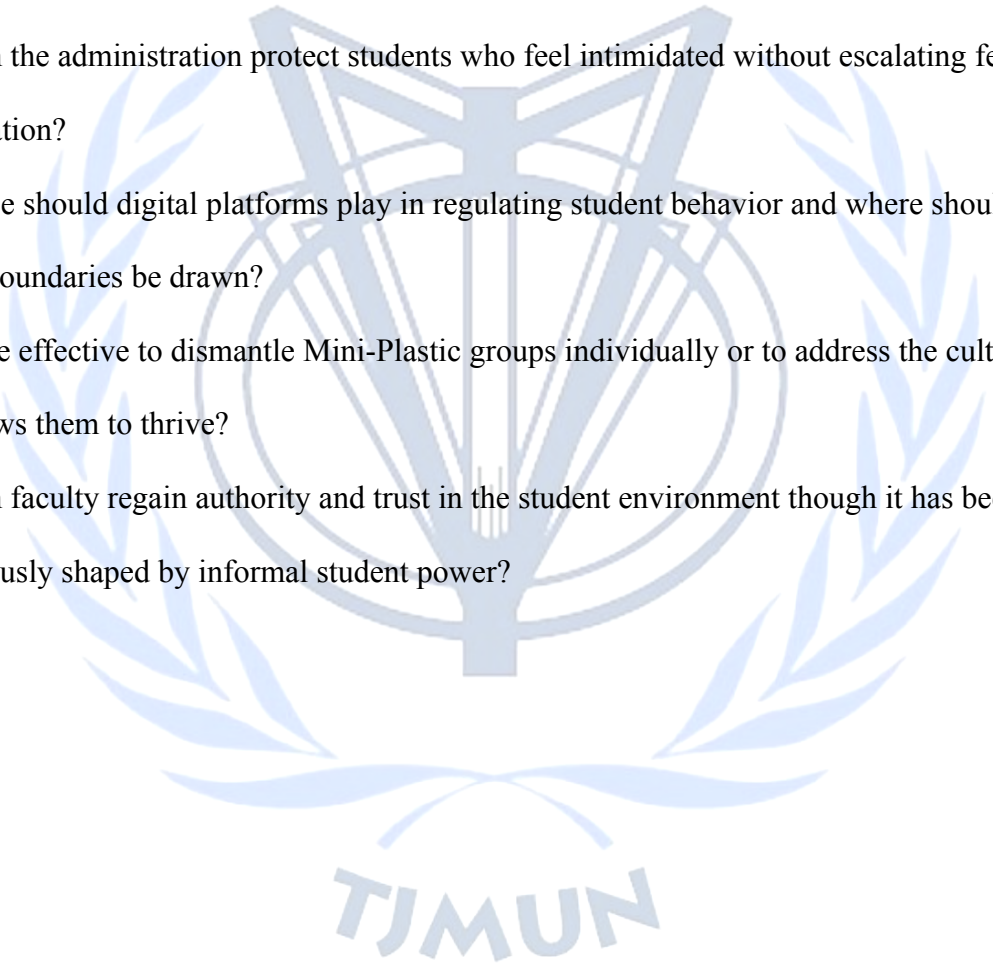
groups. The primary benefits of this approach is increased accountability and that faculty would be better equipped to monitor patterns of exclusion and which students are repeatedly causing trouble and engaging in coordinated gossip.

Additionally, younger students may be more intimidated in terms of forming harmful groups if they are aware of adult supervision. However, this approach has notable drawbacks, including excessive oversight driving the Mini-Plastic groups underground where they become harder to track and more resistant to the school administration. Students may also perceive this strategy as excessive or authoritarian, further negatively impacting the trust between the student body and the administration.

Another option that was proposed is to establish peer-led mediation programs including upperclassmen that have been members of influential social groups. These students could also serve as mentors and advisors, offering guidance based on experience that they have with social dynamics. The benefit of this strategy is reliability and credibility. Underclassmen may be more responsive to guidance from peers and upperclassmen rather than authority figures. Involving former plastics could also signal accountability. However, this approach can be controversial as many former plastics may still hold influence and could unintentionally reinforce the social power dynamics, causing schoolwide damage in terms of a social imbalance. Without strict safeguards, this strategy risks strengthening social power rather than diffusing it.

Questions to Consider

- 1) How should North Shore High respond to underclassmen who imitate past social hierarchies while denying responsibility for their consequences?
- 2) Should former Plastics have involvement in diffusion these new social groups or be excluded to prevent further influence?
- 3) How can the administration protect students who feel intimidated without escalating fear or retaliation?
- 4) What role should digital platforms play in regulating student behavior and where should certain boundaries be drawn?
- 5) Is it more effective to dismantle Mini-Plastic groups individually or to address the culture that allows them to thrive?
- 6) How can faculty regain authority and trust in the student environment though it has been continuously shaped by informal student power?



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North Shore High: Mean Girls

Regina George

Regina is the charismatic and ruthless leader of the Plastics. She controls North Shore High's social hierarchy through manipulation, intimidation, and image management. She is highly intelligent and strategic but deeply insecure, using cruelty to maintain power and dominance.

Gretchen Wieners

Gretchen is Regina's loyal second-in-command, Gretchen enforces social rules and spreads gossip to preserve the Plastics' authority. She is anxious about losing status and relies on Regina's approval for her sense of worth.

Karen Smith

The well-meaning but unintelligent member of the Plastics, Karen provides comic relief and serves as Regina's most obedient follower. She is kind-hearted and naïve, often unaware of the social cruelty around her.

Cady Heron

A former homeschooler raised in Africa, Cady enters North Shore High with no understanding of American teen social structures. Over time, she becomes corrupted by popularity and power before ultimately rejecting the hierarchy she helped reinforce.

Janis Ian

A rebellious outsider and Regina's former best friend, Janis orchestrates the downfall of the Plastics with Cady and Damian as revenge for Regina's betrayal. She is socially intelligent, sarcastic, and despises the idea of social conformity.

Damian Leigh

Janis's loyal best friend, Damian serves as emotional support and provides comedic commentary. He is confident in his identity and openly rejects the school's popularity culture.

Jason

Gretchen Wieners's ex-boyfriend, Jason is a shallow and status-driven popular boy who prioritizes social climbing over loyalty. His breakup with Gretchen highlights how disposable relationships are within North Shore's popular culture.

Ms. Norbury

Ms. Norbury is the compassionate math teacher, who mentors Cady and believes in the potential of each and every one of her students. However, she becomes an unintended victim of Regina's cruelty and the Burn Book scandal.

Kevin Gnapoor

An overly confident but intellectual mathlete, Kevin develops a strong crush on Cady. He represents loyalty and academic integrity in contrast to the school's popularity culture.

Aaron Samuels

Regina's ex-boyfriend and Cady's love interest, Aaron is kind, polite, and academically capable. He serves as a catalyst for the conflict between Cady and Regina.

Principal Duvall

Though Principal Duvall means well, he is seen as the ineffective school administrator as he attempts to restore order after the Burn Book scandal. His disciplinary methods reflect the school's lack of real accountability structures.

June George

Regina's wealthy and overly permissive mother, June, tries to be her daughter's "cool mom." She enables Regina's behavior by prioritizing popularity, looks, and her desires for her daughter.

Caroline Krafft

A highly competitive student from Marymount Prep, Caroline is the opposing finalist Cady faces in the State Mathletes Championship. She is Cady's intellectual rival in the Mathlete State Finals, and is portrayed as unconventionally attractive.

Cady's Mom

Cady's mom is a warm, supportive parent and wildlife researcher, she raises Cady with strong moral values and intellectual curiosity. Following the burn book scandal, she struggles to understand the cruelty of American teen culture.

Cady's Dad

As a gentle scientist, Cady's dad provides emotional stability and trust within Cady's home life. He is largely detached from the social drama affecting his daughter and is unaware of the burn book scandal until Cady faces punishment for it at school.

Kylie George

Regina's younger sister, Kylie idolizes her and imitates her behavior, often dancing or singing age-inappropriate songs. She hints at Regina's influence to those around her and is on the path to becoming similar to her as well.

Glen Coco

Glen Coco is a student whose name unexpectedly becomes a running joke after receiving multiple candy-gram shoutouts during the Winter Talent Show. His sudden recognition highlights the nature of popularity at North Shore High.

Trang Pak

A member of the “Asian nerds” clique, Trang is academically focused but has an overall negative attitude. She becomes one of Regina’s Burn Book victims.

Sun Jin Dinh

Sun is another member of the “Asian nerds,” an academically driven student and part of the same marginalized clique as Trang. She is also targeted by Regina’s gossip campaign.

Shane Oman

Regina’s athletic and wealthy boyfriend later in the film, Shane represents her continued fixation on status symbols. His relationship with Regina is transactional and superficial.

Coach Carr

The blunt and unethical health teacher, Coach Carr exploits his position of authority to pursue students, like Trang Pak. His character highlights institutional failure and adult misconduct.

Emma Gerber

Emma is a kind-hearted student referenced in the Burn Book as a target of Regina’s rumors. She makes amends with Cady at the Spring Fling dance, which greatly boosts her self-image.

Kristen Hadley

Another student slandered in the Burn Book. Her character is a Lacrosse player for the Lady Lions team at North Shore. She is aligned with the “Band Geeks” clique.

Amber D'Alessio

A wealthy and fashionable student aligned with the “Burnouts” clique. She was also personally victimized in the Burn Book.

Taylor Wedell

A conventionally attractive student whom Jason pursues immediately after dumping Gretchen. She then becomes personally victimized by Regina George and is forced to stop seeing Jason.